

PM CASE STUDY · NEWME · PLATFORM · 0 → 1

NPOS

Building NEWME's own point-of-sale — the operating system for offline retail.

The starting point: NEWME's offline expansion ran on a third-party POS (Olabi) at ₹30K per store per month — with customizations that were hard to get and new features billed extra. My brief as PM: own the system that owns our inventory truth.

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Why build, when you could buy

Buy is right when software is a utility. A POS is the operating system of the stores — and AI has moved the build-vs-buy line.



₹30K per store, every month

License costs scaled linearly with expansion — at 25 stores, ~₹90L a year, forever.



Customization on someone else's roadmap

Changes were hard to get, and every new feature came with an extra bill.



Inventory truth lived outside

Online + offline needed one real-time stock source — not a synced copy in a vendor's system.



Two very different users

Store staff at the counter and retail admins at HQ — one system had to serve both.

The bet: build our own POS. AI-assisted development compressed the build to 6 weeks — a disciplined v1 (billing, inwarding, offer management) first, then module by module into the full retail OS.

Decisions that made it work

An internal tool competes with the muscle memory of the tool it replaces — every call optimized for staff trust.



Research done standing at the counter

Proactive store visits instead of second-hand briefs from office rooms — watching staff bill, inward and count stock firsthand shaped what got built, and in what order.



Requirements triangulated, not transcribed

No single ask was treated as set in stone. Talking across store staff, retail admins and ops revealed the broader problem behind each request — and what was actually worth building.



A disciplined v1, not a feature-for-feature clone

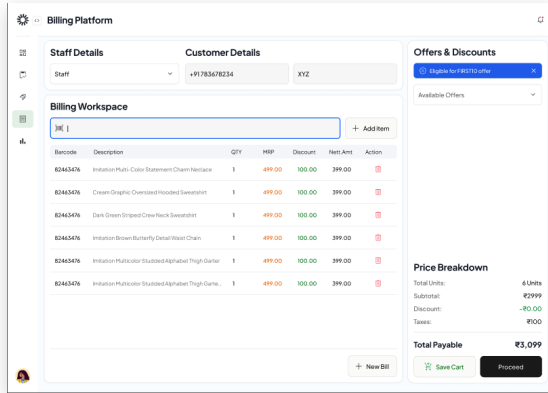
Billing, inwarding and offer management shipped first — what a store needs to open its doors. Outwarding, audits, reports and bulk actions followed once the core had earned trust.



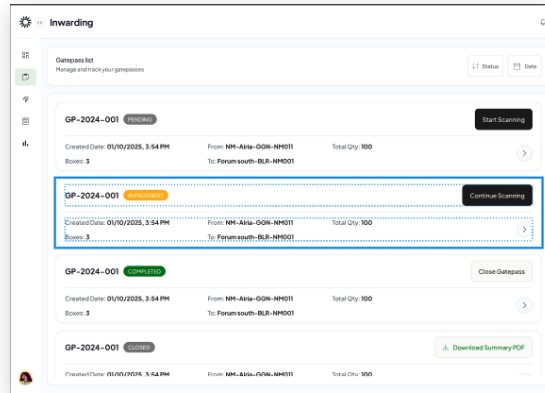
A rollout designed to protect trust

1 store in week 1 to catch breakages, 5 in week 2, then region-wise to 25 stores in 4 weeks. Staff trusted the old tool; one broken billing day would burn the new one.

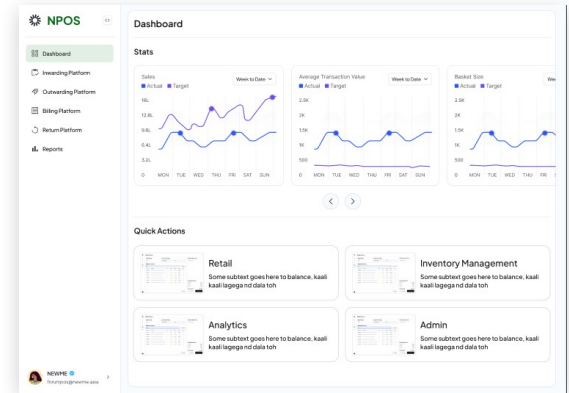
How the decisions showed up in product



Billing built for the counter — barcode-first, offers auto-applied, save-cart and split payments



Inwarding by scan — expected vs scanned reconciled at box level, written to live inventory



The admin command centre — store health, offers, bulk actions and audits, centrally controlled

What it moved

Measured against cost per store and inventory accuracy — the two things the build had to win on.

25

stores live in 4 weeks —
region-wise, after a 6-week build



₹90L a year, off the books

Recurring licenses (₹30K/store/month) replaced by a one-time build — and the saving compounds with every new store opened.



One source of inventory truth

Real-time stock across billing, inwarding and outwarding; audit scans surface shrinkage per store.



A roadmap we own

AI-assisted development keeps new modules shipping on NEWME's timeline, at zero marginal license cost.

Takeaway: errors burn the trust staff had in the old tool — for systems like POS, building it correctly beats building it fast.